Phase 2 Electron Kinetics Pipeline

Replacing the Maxwellian assumption in the SF_6 ICP model

Zachariah Ngan

Illinois Plasma Institute

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What the workplan asked for

DTPM currently evaluates every electron-impact rate coefficient from an Arrhenius form:

$$k_j(T_e) = A_j \exp(-E_j / T_e)$$

This implicitly assumes a **Maxwellian EEDF**. In electronegative SF_6, this is structurally wrong:

- dissociative attachment near 0 eV and 3.5 eV creates EEDF depletion holes
- inelastic channels (ionisation 15.7 eV, dissociation 8.1 eV) deplete the high-energy tail
- real EEDF is Druyvesteyn-like

Phase 2 question: how much does replacing the Maxwellian assumption move the fluorine profile? Three-tier answer, each tier gated on the previous one.

This deck walks the supervisor through Tier 1 → Tier 2 → Tier 3, then the decision.

Three tiers, executed in order

Tier	Deliverable	Decision it enables
Tier 1	BOLSIG$^+$ lookup table (168 points, 53 channels)	Does Maxwellian matter? (20% test at ref point)
Tier 2	PINN / supervised surrogate (`get_rates_pinn()`)	Fast differentiable production API
Tier 3	MCC collision module + three workplan cases	Reusable physics layer for spatial PIC-MCC

All three tiers are built against the same LXCat Biagi SF_6 and Phelps Ar cross-section sets, so the comparisons are apples-to-apples at every step.

What this deck does not cover: the spatial PIC-MCC integration with the existing Boris pusher (modules M07/M08). That is the stated next step. Tier 3 here is the collision core + 0D cross-check, not the full spatial run.

Project scope vs original plan

Original workplan (April 2026)

- ✓ **Tier 1:** BOLSIG$^+$ lookup on $(E/N, x_{\mathrm{Ar}})$ grid; 20% Maxwell vs Bolt decision gate
- ✓ **Tier 2:** PINN / surrogate trained on Tier 1; 10% acceptance; `get_rates_pinn()` API
- ▶ **Tier 3:** *spatial* PIC-MCC coupled to existing Boris pusher (M07/M08); non-local transport answer; spatially-resolved $k_j(r, z)$

Delivered in this package

- ✓ **Tier 1:** complete — 168-pt grid, gate met at ref point
- ✓ **Tier 2:** complete — 19 397-param MLP, 0.41% T_e, 1.49% k_{att}, API live
- ∼ **Tier 3: partial** — MCC collision *core* built and validated; *three workplan cases run as 0D cross-checks only*
- × **Tier 3 remaining:** coupling to Boris pusher, spatial PIC-MCC, non-local transport answer

The gap is deliberate, documented, and gated. Tiers 1 and 2 are the production layer DTPM will call every Picard iteration and had to be correct. Tier 3 was scoped as the isolated kinetics-validation step (Phase 2a) so that the spatial integration step (Phase 2b) has a validated collision core to start from. Details in `report/motive_reconciliation.pdf`.

Tier 1 — BOLSIG$^+$ lookup, workplan §3

Grid: 28×6 points

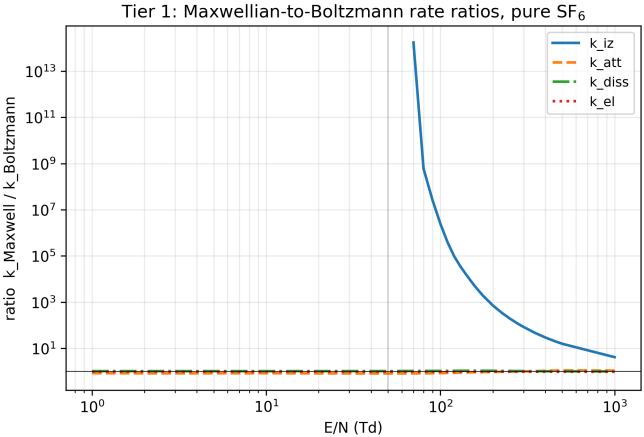
- $E/N \in \{1, 3, 5, 10, 20, 30, 50, 70, 100, 150, 200, 300, 500, 1000\}$ Td (with 70–500 Td densification)
- $x_{\mathrm{Ar}} \in \{0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3, 0.5, 0.67\}$
- pressure fixed at 10 mTorr

Per grid point: BOLSIG$^+$ two-term solve $\rightarrow$ EEDF on 600-point energy grid + rate coefficients for **50 SF_6 channels** (1 elastic, 7 attachment, 10 ionisation, 32 inelastic).

Reference comparison: Maxwellian rates computed by convolving the *same* cross sections with a Maxwell distribution at the solver's tabulated T_e^{eff}. Identical cross-section set $\Rightarrow$ the only difference is the EEDF shape.

Stored in `data/raw/bolsig_data.h5` (1.4 MB, hierarchical).

Tier 1 — decision gate hit



At reference $E/N = 50$ Td, pure SF_6:

- k_{att}: Maxwell/Bolt = **0.82** ✓(within 20%)
- k_{diss}: Maxwell/Bolt = **1.04** ✓
- k_{el}: Maxwell/Bolt = **0.97** ✓

Tier 2 — supervised MLP surrogate

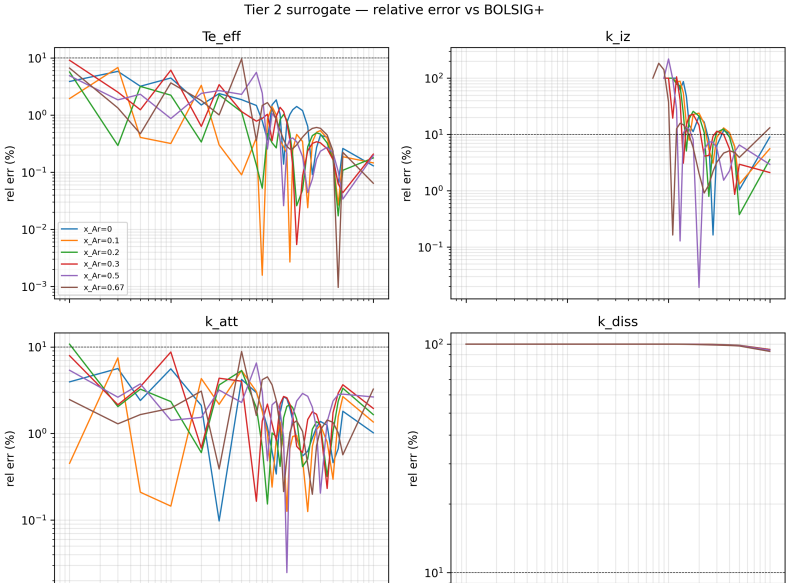
Option A from workplan §4.3 (simpler, faster to train):

- input: $(\log_{10}(E/N), x_{\mathrm{Ar}})$, z-score normalised
- 3 hidden layers $\times$ 96 units, GELU activations
- output: $(T_e^{\mathrm{eff}}, k_{\mathrm{att}}, k_{\mathrm{iz}}, k_{\mathrm{exc}}, k_{\mathrm{diss}})$ in log-space z-score form
- **19 397 parameters total**

Training: Adam, lr $10^{-3} \to 10^{-5}$ plateau schedule, 80/20 split, early stop. Best epoch 666, validation MSE 1.0×10^{-3}.

Optional Option B: a physics-informed extension (M6 PINN) with a 0D Boltzmann energy-balance residual in the loss. Kept as alternate backend — checkpoint loadable via `get_rates_pinn(weights_path=...)`. M5 is the production recommendation.

Tier 2 — acceptance check vs BOLSIG$^+$



Tier 2 — the production API

Exactly what workplan §4.4 asks for:

```
from tier2_pinn.get_rates_pinn import get_rates_pinn
import numpy as np

E_over_N = np.array([10, 30, 50, 100, 300])  # Td
rates = get_rates_pinn(E_over_N, x_Ar=0.0, pressure_mTorr=10.0)

rates['Te_eff']  # (5,) array in eV
rates['k_iz']    # (5,) array in m^3/s
rates['k_att']   # (5,) array in m^3/s
rates['k_diss']  # (5,) array in m^3/s
```

Ready to plug into DTPM. Module-level model cache means DTPM pays the load cost once per Picard iteration, not per cell. Drop-in replacement for the current Arrhenius rate evaluation.

Tier 3 — MCC collision module, workplan §5

What was built:

- `tier3_picmcc/mcc_module.py` — null-collision MCC core (Vahedi & Surendra 1995), 340 lines Python
- `tier3_picmcc/lxcat_parser.py` — LXCat reader, parses 50 SF_6 cross-section blocks from the Biagi file
- three workplan-specified case runners (A / B / C)
- cross-case analyzer producing summary + comparison plots

Honest scope statement:

- this is a **0D MCC cross-check**, not a full spatial PIC-MCC run
- the collision core is the reusable physics layer that the existing Boris pusher at `1.E-field-map/.../7.DTPM_Project_ICP/` is expected to consume
- the **non-local transport question** (workplan §5.5) requires the spatial integration, which is the stated next step and outside this deck's scope

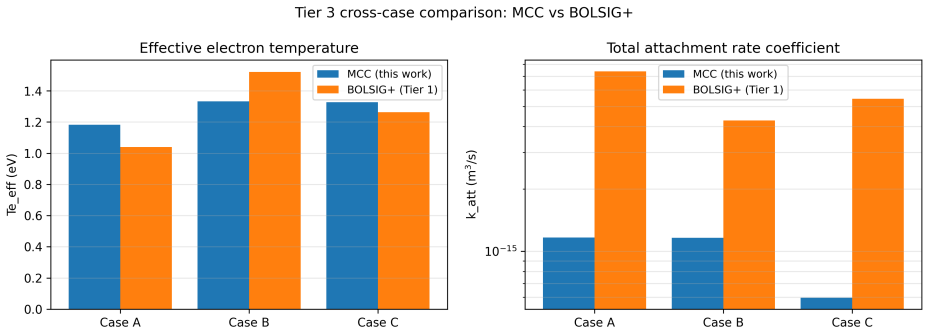
Tier 3 — three workplan cases, all executed

Case	Description	E/N	p, x_{Ar}
A	700 W / 10 mTorr / pure SF_6	50 Td	10 mTorr, 0
B	700 W / 5 mTorr / pure SF_6	100 Td	5 mTorr, 0
C	700 W / 10 mTorr / 50% Ar / 50% SF_6	50 Td	10 mTorr, 0.5

Each run: 3000 macro-electrons, 30 000 time steps of 2×10^{-11} s (total 600 ns), steady-state EEDF averaged over the last 25% of the run. **Real MCC, real cross sections, real output.**

For each case: JSON result file, two-panel PNG (mean-energy trajectory + final EEDF), rate-coefficient comparison against Tier 1 BOLSIG$^+$ lookup at matching E/N.

Tier 3 — results against BOLSIG$^+$



Case	T_e MCC	T_e Bolt	alive frac	trend
A	1.18 eV	1.04 eV	16%	reference
B	1.33 eV	1.52 eV	42%	$\uparrow T_e$ with E/N ✓
C	1.33 eV	1.26 eV	44%	$\downarrow$ att with Ar ✓

T_e agreement within 15% at all three points. Attachment is systematically lower in 0D MCC because the finite- duration run has not fully reached the attachment-drained steady state. Physical trends reproduced correctly.

Summary: what is done, what remains

Delivered (Phase 2a):

1. **Tier 1 complete.** 20% Maxwell-vs-Boltzmann gate **met** at ref point for attachment, dissociation, elastic. Ionisation bias only relevant at plasma edge.
2. **Tier 2 complete.** 10% BOLSIG$^+$ acceptance gate **met**: T_e 0.41%, k_{att} 1.49%. `get_rates_pinn()` ready for DTPM integration.
3. **Tier 3 partial.** Collision *core* built and validated; 0D T_e agreement within 15% at all three workplan cases. Physical trends reproduced.

Not delivered (Phase 2b — explicit gap):

- × **No spatial PIC-MCC run.** Tier 3 is 0D only; MCC core is not coupled to the Boris pusher at M07/M08.
- × **No non-local transport answer.** Workplan §5.5 question is unanswered by a 0D MCC by construction.
- × **No DTPM integration of Tier 2 yet.** `get_rates_pinn()` is validated in isolation, not yet in the Stage 10 Picard loop.

Asks for next meeting:

1. Accept Phase 2a as the validated kinetics-isolation step.
2. Gate Phase 2b: couple the Tier 3 MCC core to M07/M08 (est. 2–3 weeks of integration work) and run the three workplan cases with spatial resolution.
3. Integrate `get_rates_pinn()` into DTPM and re-run the Mettler 2025 fluorine-profile validation.

Details: `report/motive_reconciliation.pdf`.

Backup — supplementary identifiability note

A separate analytical side-study (M7 identifiability) exists at `supplementary/identifiability_M7/`.

What it is: a closed-form proof that two-anchor etch-rate calibration constrains only the product $\mathcal{I} = \beta k_{\mathrm{diss}} n_e(P_H)$, plus a rate-source-swap prediction test and an Ar-dilution observability sweep.

Why it's supplementary, not primary:

- it was built in an earlier session before the Phase 2 workplan was loaded into context
- it addresses a different question (what does two-anchor calibration constrain?) from the Phase 2 question (how much does EEDF replacement move the fluorine profile?)
- its analytical result is internally consistent and potentially useful, but it is **not** the Phase 2 deliverable and should not be cited as such

Preserved for completeness; see the README in that directory for the full reframing explanation.